Design Thinking

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WORLD ECONOMIC FORUM

Top 10 skills of 2025

- Analytical thinking and innovation
- Active learning and learning strategies
- Complex problem-solving
- Critical thinking and analysis
- Creativity, originality and initiative
- Leadership and social influence
- Technology use, monitoring and control
- Technology design and programming
- Resilience, stress tolerance and flexibility
- Reasoning, problem-solving and ideation

Type of skill

- Problem-solving
- Self-management
- Working with people
- Technology use and development

Source: Future of Jobs Report 2020, World Economic Forum.

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A small team, committed to a cause bigger than themselves, can achieve absolutely anything.
Simon Sinek
quotefancy

What are benefits to collaboration?

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Where do good Ideas come from?

Solving a problem
Doing something you love
Design thinking
Spontaneous

“Great ideas come when you aren’t trying to think of them.”

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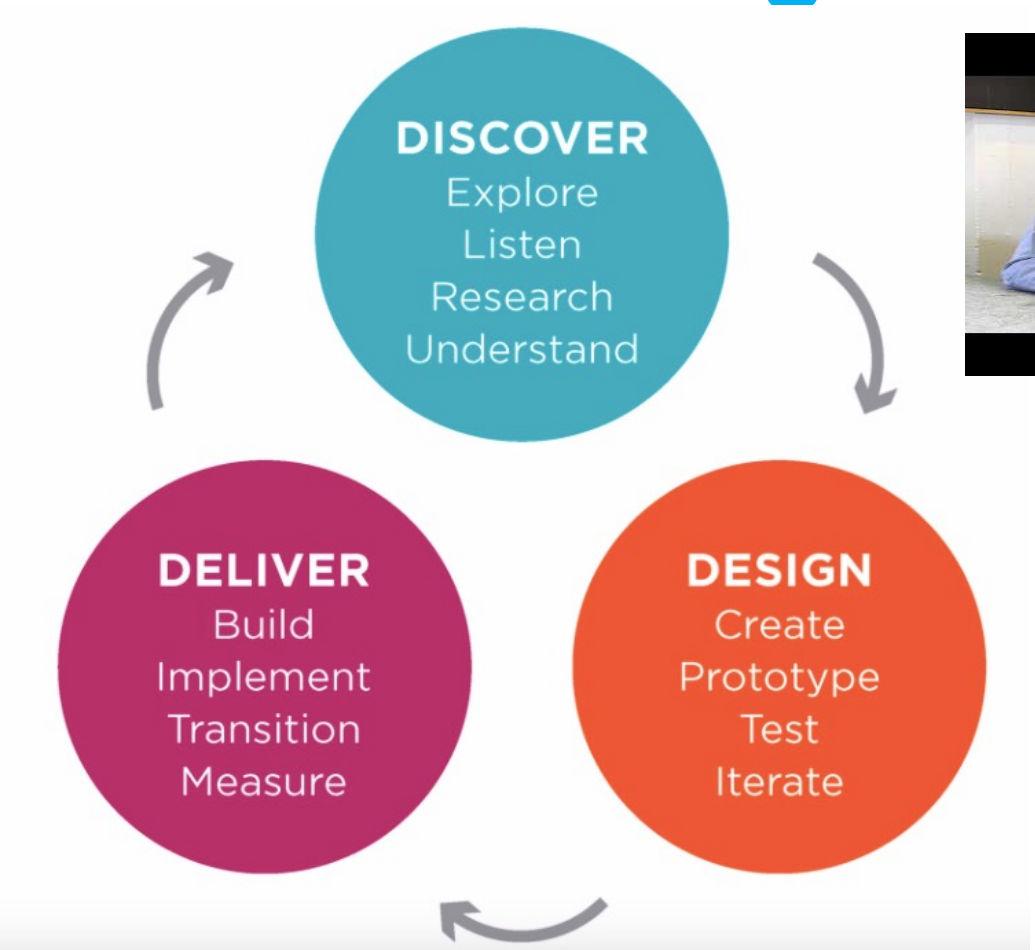
Human Centred Design



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Design Thinking Stages

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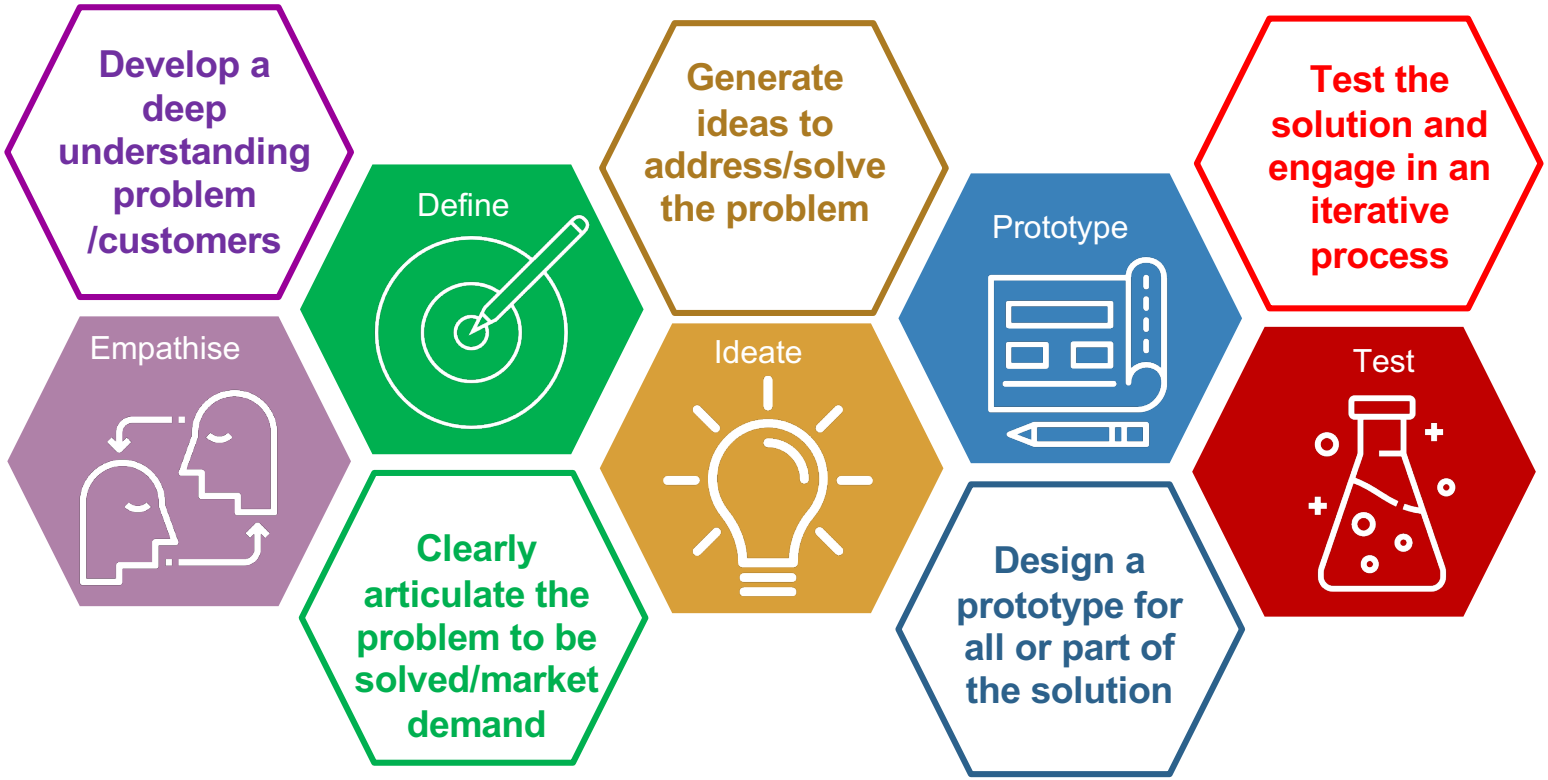
Design thinking process



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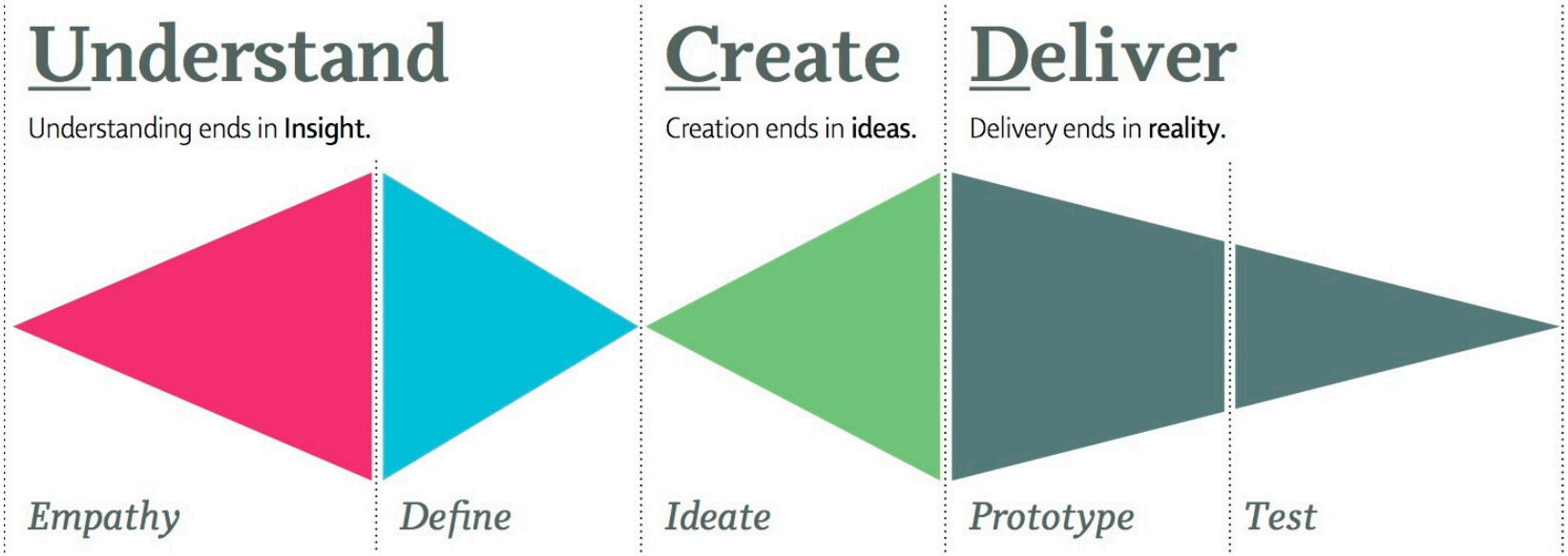

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HOW to empathise

- Own experience
- Observe
- Engage
- Watch and Listen
- Research
- Empathy maps
- Customer/user journey maps

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What does she

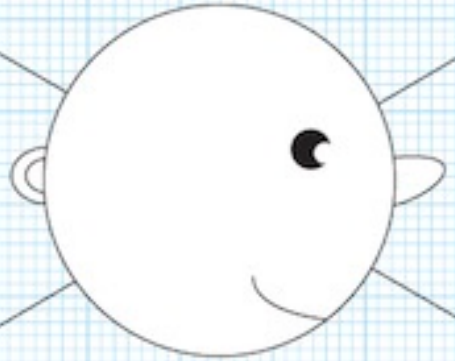
THINK AND FEEL?

what really counts
major preoccupations
worries & aspirations

What does she

HEAR?

what friends say
what boss says
what influencers say



What does she

SEE?

environment
friends
what the market offers

What does she

SAY AND DO?

attitude in public
appearance
behavior toward others

PAIN

fears
frustrations
obstacles

GAIN

wants/needs
measures of success
obstacles

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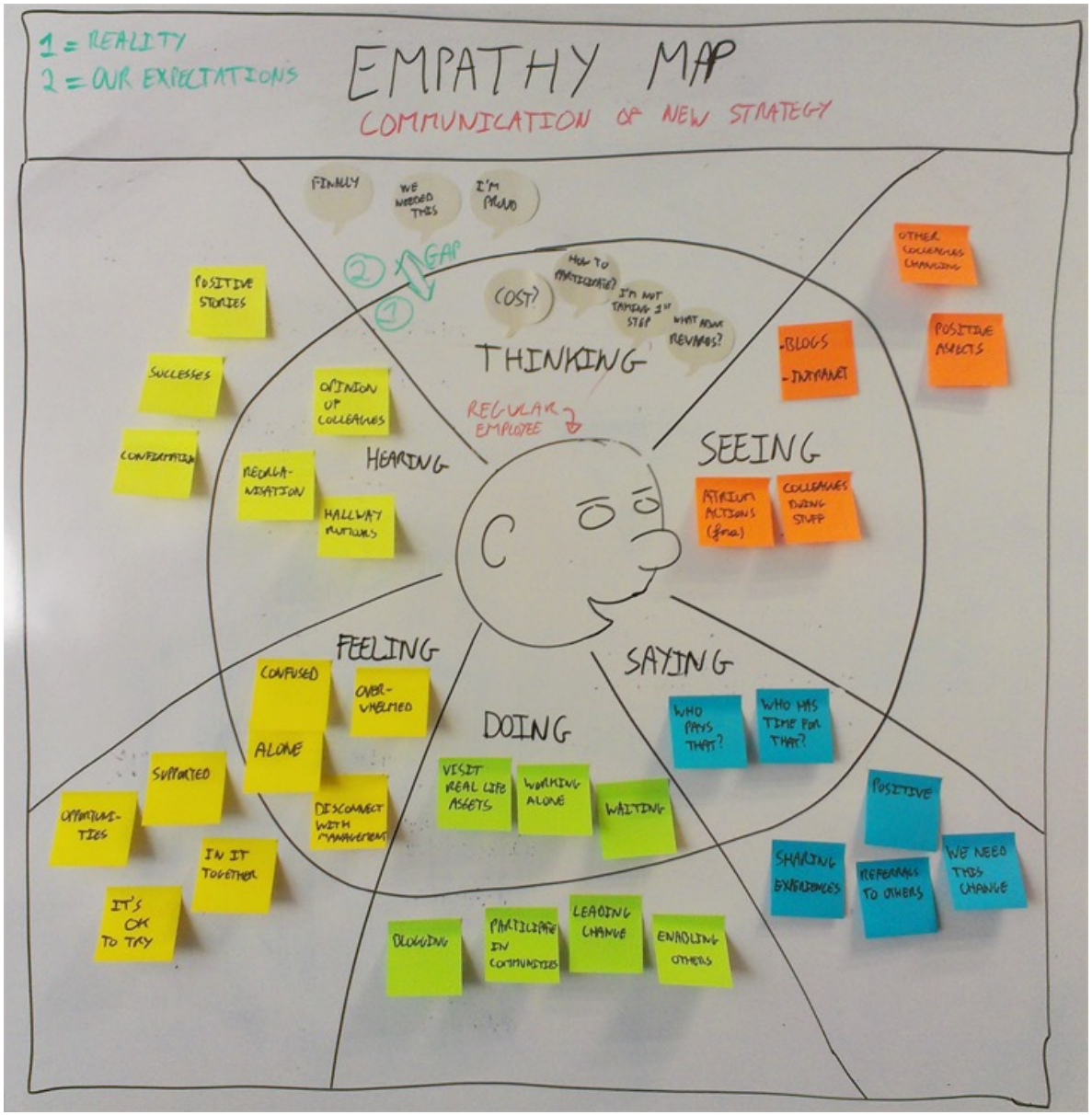

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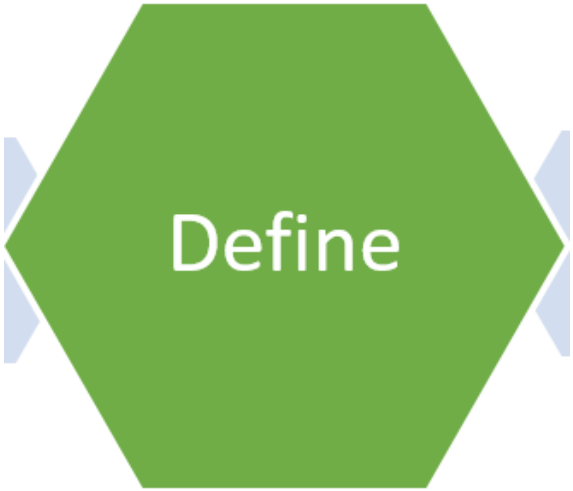
Define

"Framing the right problem is the only way to create the right solution."



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Ideate & design thinking

"It's not about coming up with the 'right' idea, it's about generating the broadest range of possibilities."

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1-2-3 Exercise

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Yes, But vs. Yes, And

- Yes, But –

Part One: Person A suggests doing something with Person B, who has to answer with a reason not to do it, starting with “Yes, but…” Person A responds with a counter-suggestion also using “Yes, but…” (Example: *Person A: “Let’s go to the grocery store.” Person B: “Yes, but our refrigerator is broken.” Person A: “Yes, but, we still need to eat.”*)

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Yes, And

- Yes, And –

Part Two: Person A makes a suggestion, but now Person B answers with “Yes, and…” And so on… (Example: Person A: *“Let’s go to the grocery store.” Person B: “Yes, and let’s get avocados.” Person A: Yes, and let’s make guacamole.”)*

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Come up with as many ways to use this as you can….

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Come up with as many ways to use this as you can….

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Identify a challenge.

ex. You can't eat ice-cream everywhere you want to

Don't assume the answer in the question.

ex. How might we create a dripless ice cream cone?

Be open enough for discovery, be specific enough for direction.

ex. How might we redesign ice-cream to be more portable?

THE BRIEF

Formulate *"How Might We..."* questions

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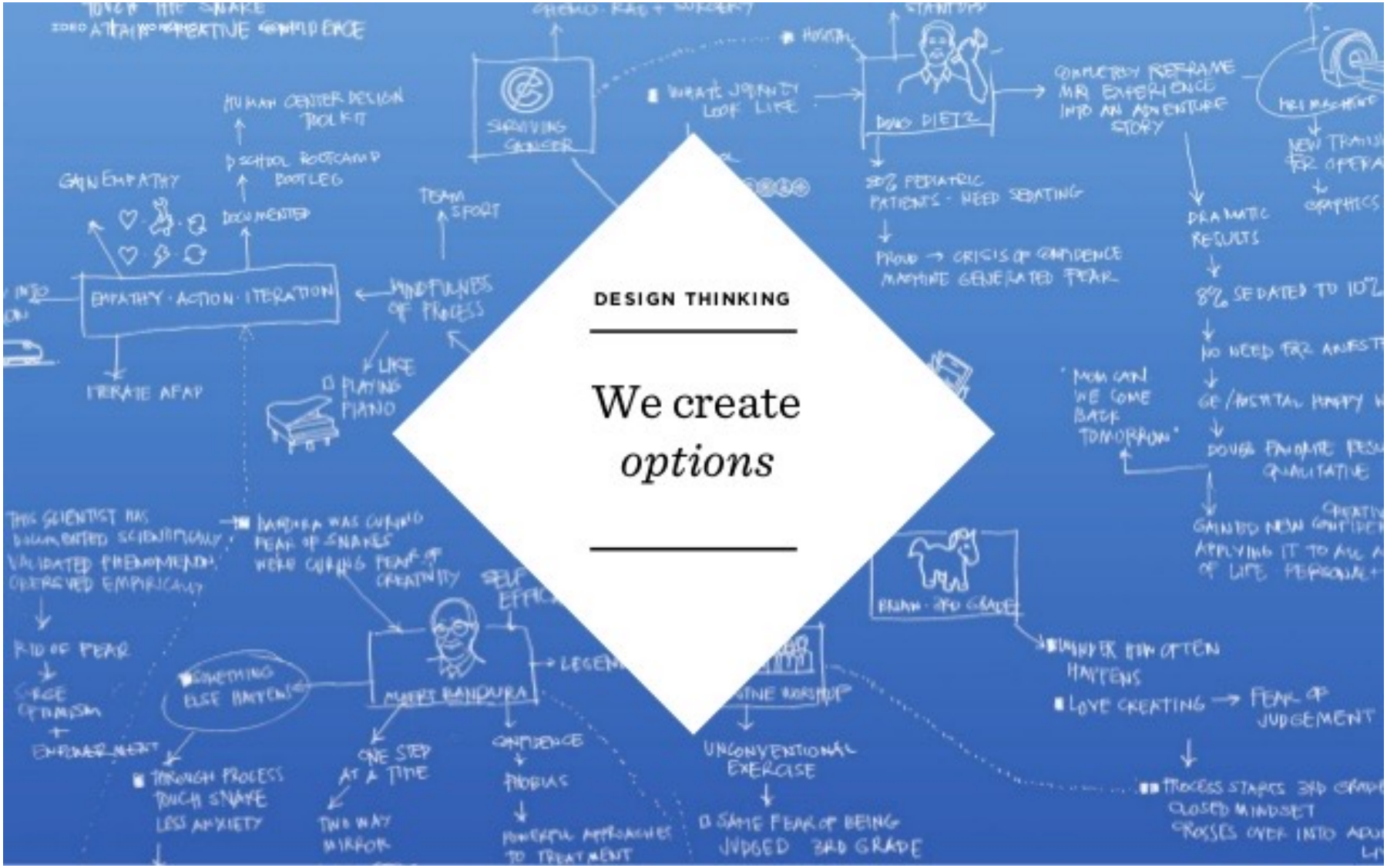

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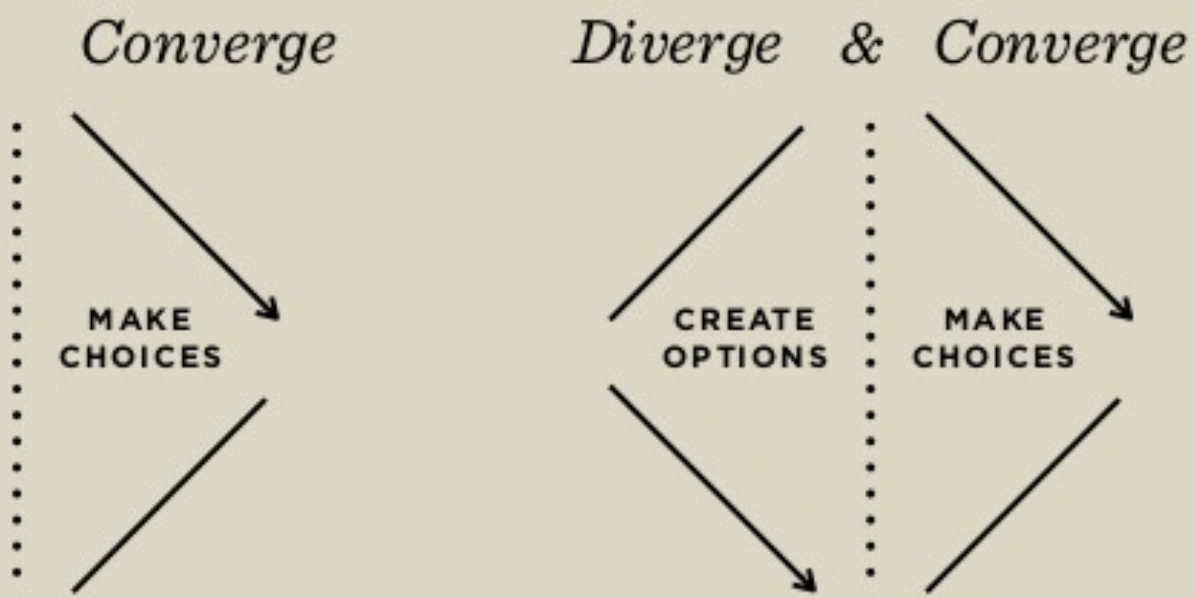

Conventional Business Practise Vs. *Design Thinking Approach*

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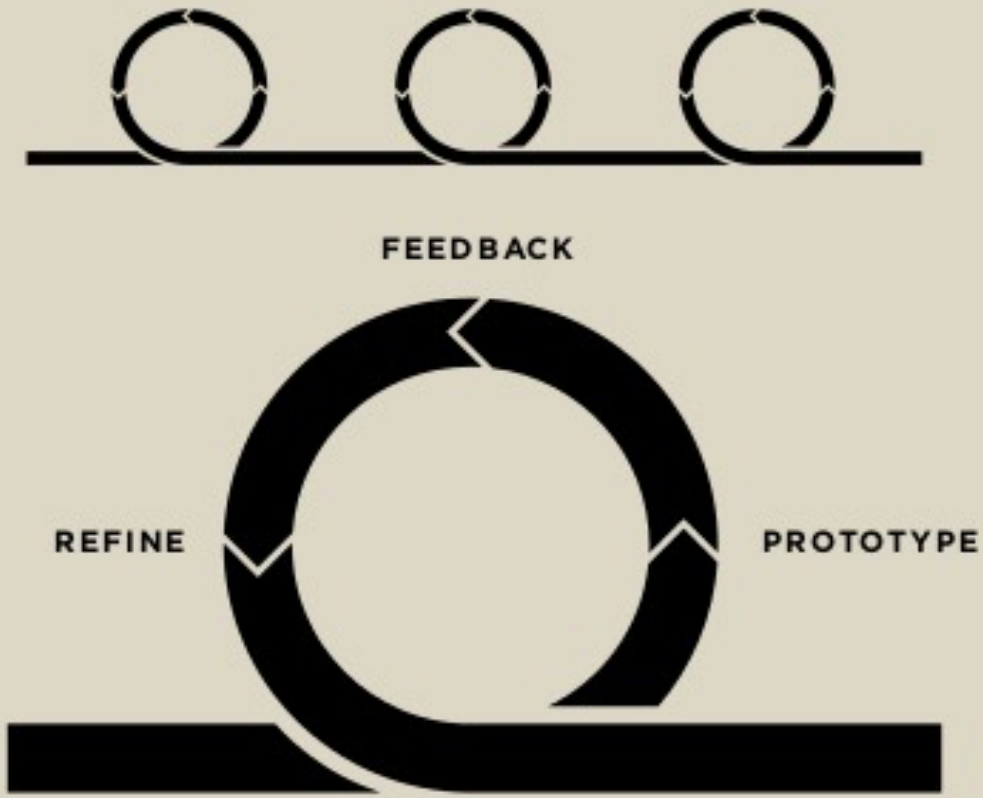

Iterate. Iterate. Iterate *again*

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DESIGN RESEARCH

Observe and listen *in context*

As people don't always *say* what they *do*, or *why*.

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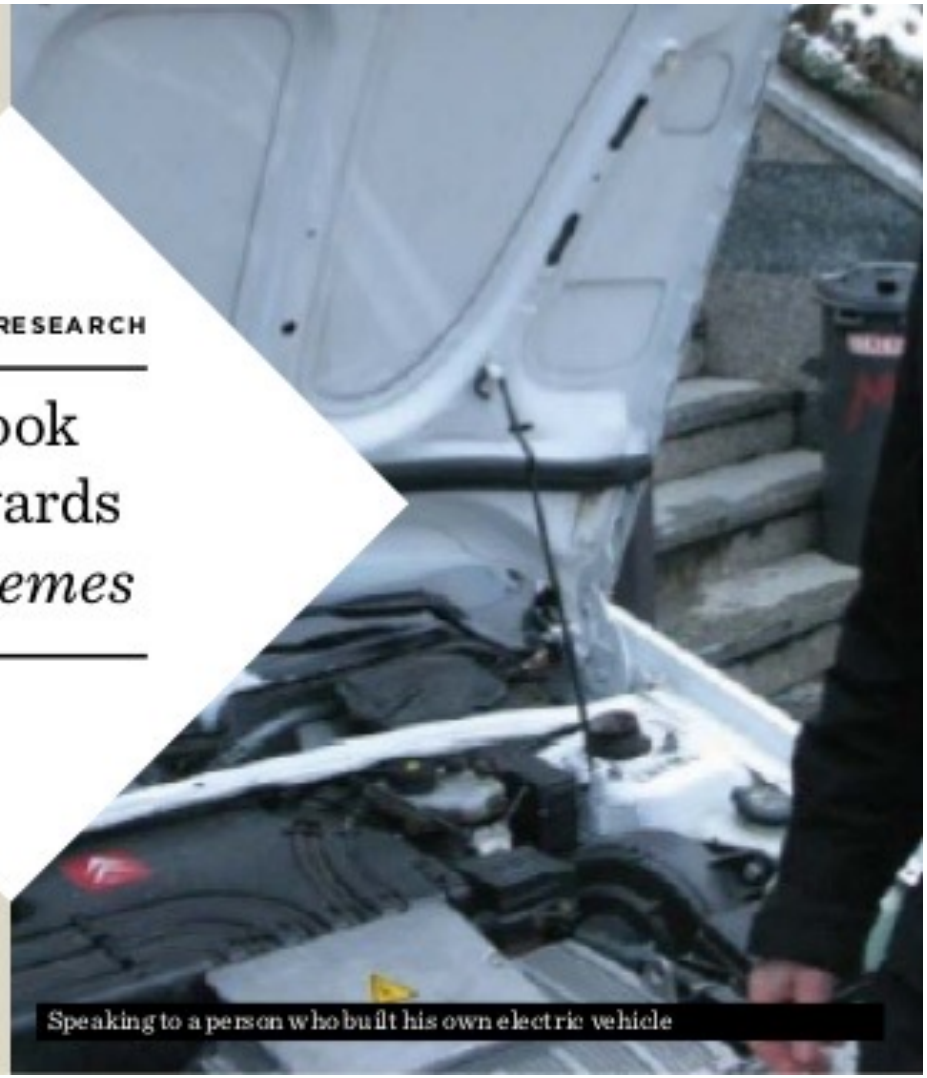
DESIGN RESEARCH

Look towards *extremes*



Speaking to a person who built his own electric vehicle

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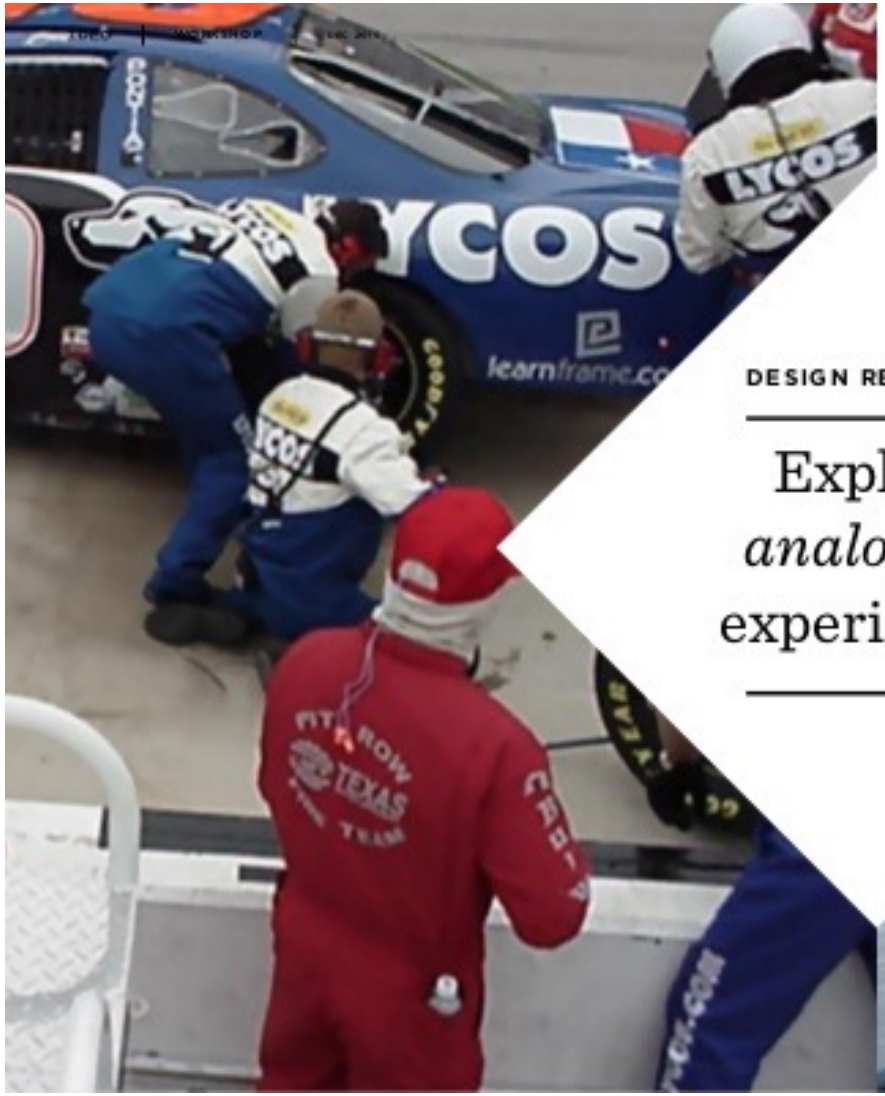

DESIGN RESEARCH

Explore *analogous* experiences

Experiencing what it's like to ride in a self-driving car by riding a tandem bike

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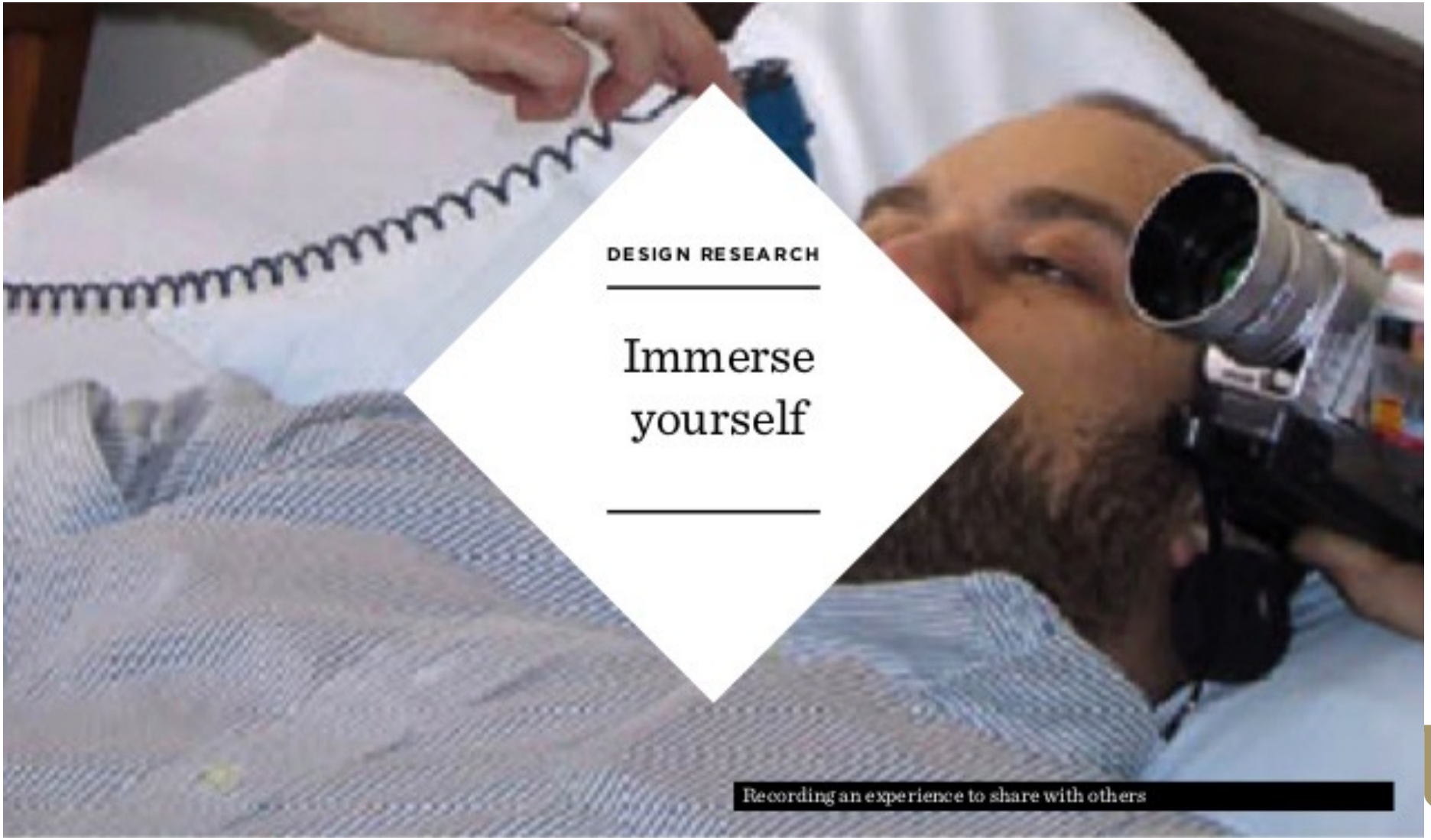

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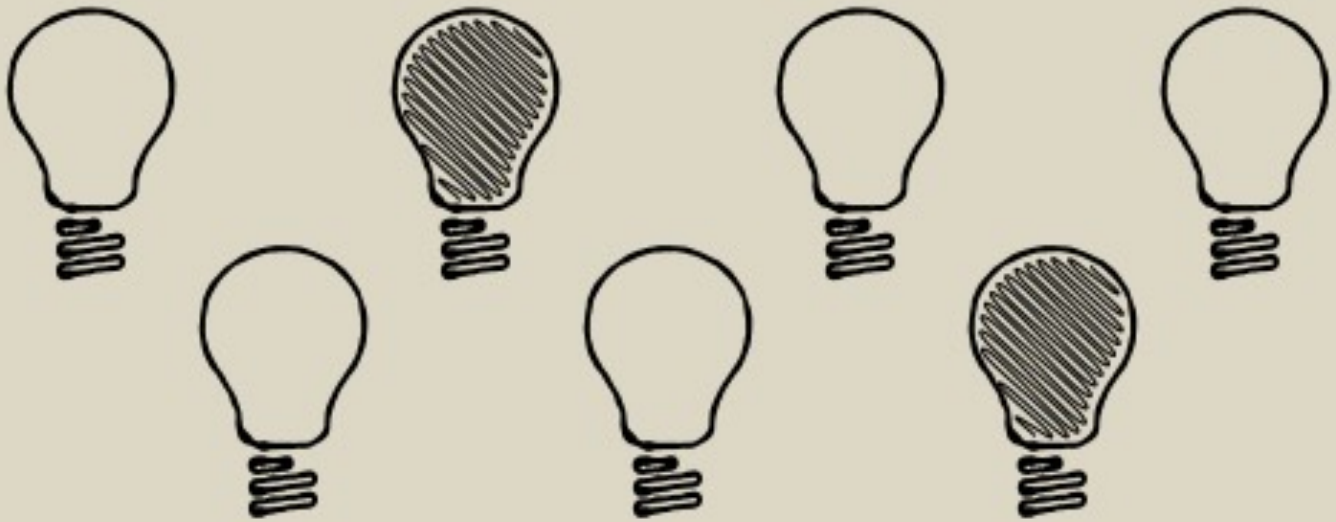
"If you want to have *good ideas* you must have many ideas"

Linus Pauling
Nobel Prize winning Chemist



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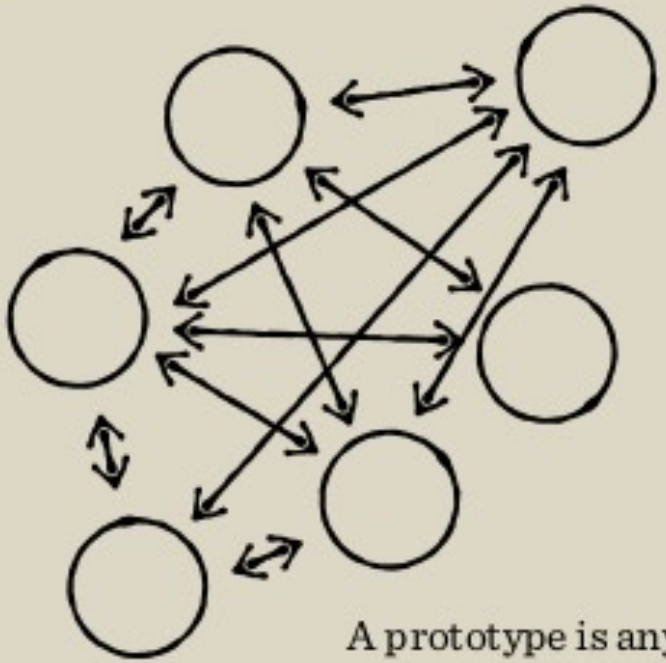
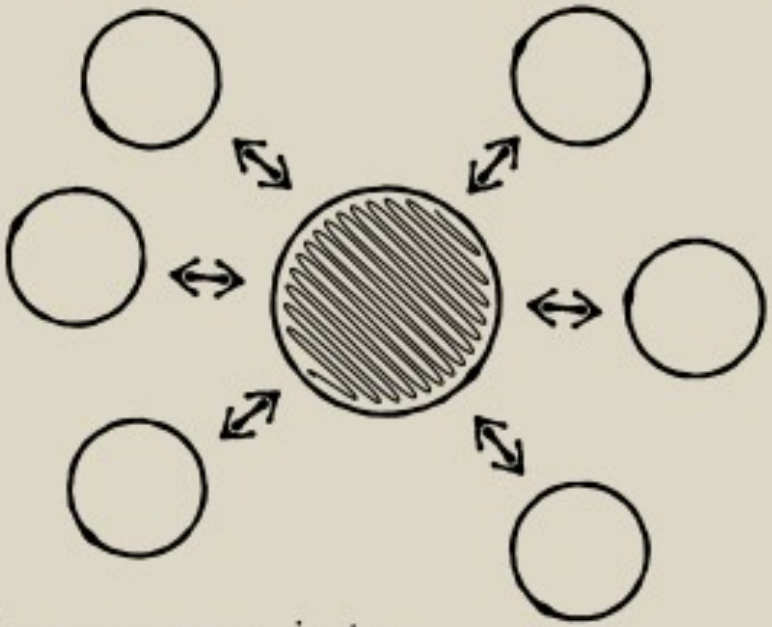
"Prototyping allows us to *fail early* so we can succeed sooner"

David Kelley
IDEO Founder





A prototype is anything that helps you communicate or test an experience with other people to get feedback

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GENERATING IDEAS

How we do it

BRAINSTORM RULES

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GENERATING IDEAS

Defer *judgement*

There are no bad ideas at this point.
There's plenty of time to judge later.

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GENERATING IDEAS

Encourage *wild* ideas

It's the wild ideas that often provide the breakthroughs. It is always easy to bring ideas down to earth later.

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GENERATING IDEAS

Build on the ideas of others

Think 'and' rather than 'but'.

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GENERATING IDEAS

Stay *focussed* on the topic

You get better output if everyone is disciplined.

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1

GENERATING IDEAS

One *conversation* at a time

That way all ideas can be heard and built upon.

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GENERATING IDEAS

Be *visual*

Try to engage the left and right side of the brain.

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GENERATING IDEAS

Headline
your idea

Communicate the essence,
without a long speech.

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GENERATING IDEAS

Go for *quantity* (not quality)

Set an outrageous goal and surpass it.

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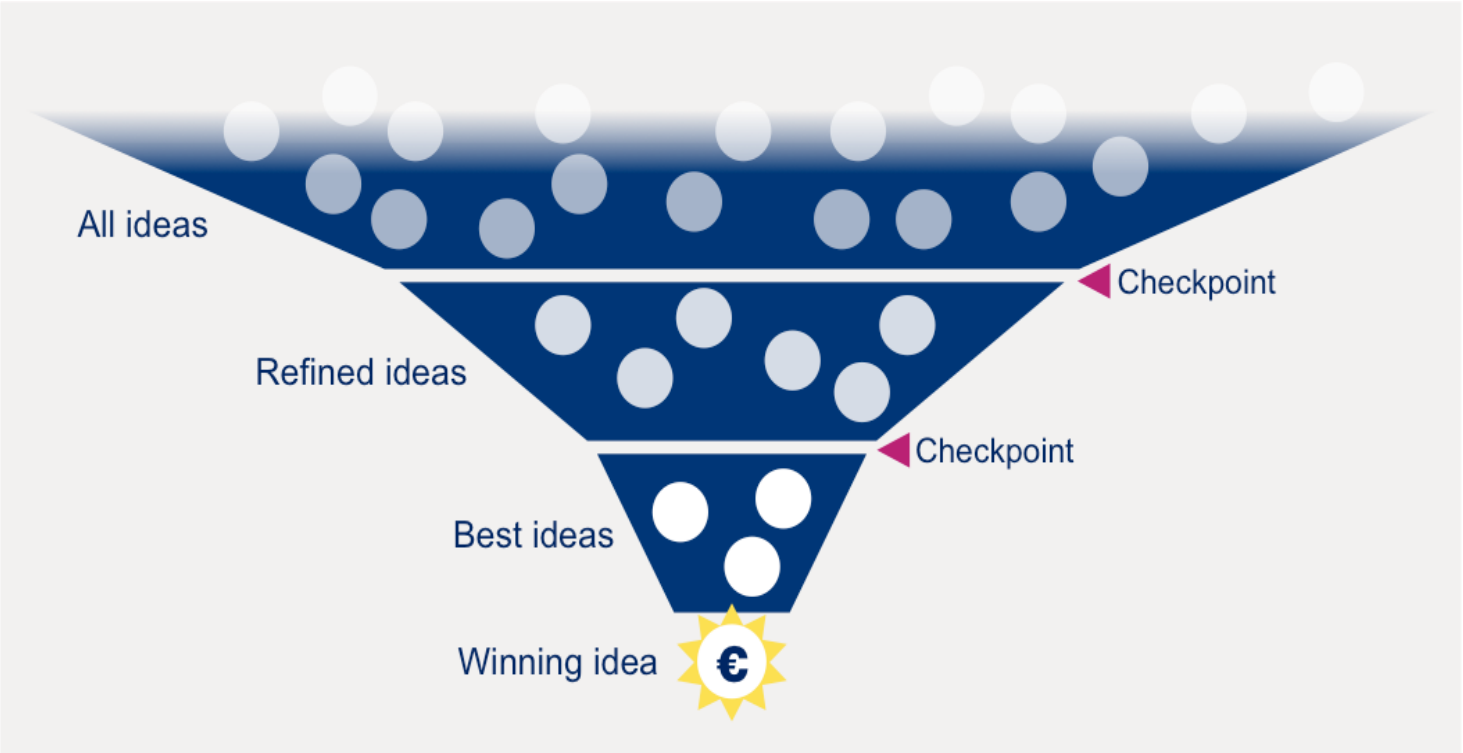
Funnel ideas



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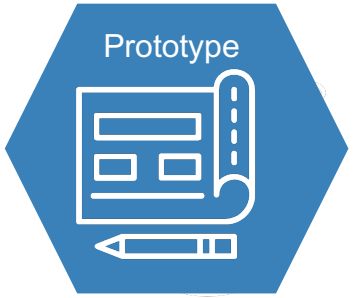
Prototype - the solution

- Idea
- Name/brand
- Images (what does it look like?)
- Features
- Pricing



Design a prototype for all or part of the solution

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Testing

- Functional testing
- Software testing
- Ethical hacker testing
- Integration testing
- Market testing
- Brand acceptance

Test the solution and engage in an iterative process

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